

Muncie Parks Department Meeting November 19th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wmr9w4pOFuc
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Target Category	muncie_city

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board/Committee: MSY Park and Recreation Board

Meeting Date: Tuesday, November 19, 2025

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the MSY Park and Recreation Board meeting to order on Tuesday, November 19, 2025.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Chra Pars, James Lutton, Mark Irving, Shannon Powers, Brad Marshall.
 - **Absent:** *(None noted in the transcript)*
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly stated by name, but leading procedural actions.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the October meeting were presented. Approved by voice vote with no discussion or revisions.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:18:24 MSC Cardinal Classic Baseball Tournament Series 2025

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** George Foley (Parks Programming and Event Approvals) on behalf of John Anderson (Executive Director, Muncie Sports Commission).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to use the baseball field at Game Bridge for the MSC Cardinal Classic Baseball Tournament series across multiple weekends in June and July 2025 (June 6-8, June 13-15, June 20-22, June 27-29, July 11-13, and July 18-20, from 9:00 AM to 8:00 PM). The organizer requested use of the park's PA system and provided liability insurance. Board members raised concerns regarding potential schedule conflicts with pre-existing agreements (such as Legion Baseball) and the lack of clarity on youth event security provisions.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled until the December meeting to allow staff to gather schedule coordination details and security clarifications.

00:40:04 Prairie Creek Reservoir Wedding Event Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tonic (Prairie Creek Reservoir Representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for Jackie Cisco's wedding and reception on May 17, from 8:00 AM to 11:00 PM, accommodating 50 to 80 people. The wedding will take place on the east side of the reservoir (coordinating with American Water on exact location), and the reception will be held in the community building. It is a private event with no commercial vendors requesting additional park services.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:43:07 Old Business: Prairie Creek Rules & Leases

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tonic and Superintendent Carl Malone.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding updated Prairie Creek rules and 2025 dock/campground leases. Minor updates include the requirement for marine-grade lines for dock holders to protect new docks from damage. Leases are scheduled to be sent out in mid-January 2025.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - *Rules:* Deferred for a vote until the December meeting after marked-up copies are provided to board members.

- *Leases:* Approved by Voice Vote (with one abstention recorded).

00:48:47 Resolution for “Passing of the Buffalo” Statue Restoration Funds

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mara Hoff (Partner, DeFur Voran, representing Community Enhancement Projects Inc. [CEP]).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal to authorize the release of available funds (approximately \$32,000 balance) from a designated Community Foundation endowment established for the preservation and maintenance of the “Passing of the Buffalo” statue, bronze plaques, and granite boulder base. The funds would be redirected directly to CEP, a 501(c)(3) entity taking over financial management and reporting. The total project estimate is \$55,000, with CEP securing private funding for the remainder, meaning zero cost to the city. Legal counsel noted that these are restricted funds exempt from standard municipal competitive bidding thresholds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:23:08 Thaddius Kiisk (Prairie Creek Trails Volunteer):** Attended with several fellow volunteers (Mike O’Neal, Jeff Fuller, Todd Bree, Dell Brinon, Shannon Ashby) to introduce the Prairie Creek Trails volunteer group. Noted that the group has volunteered thousands of hours and personal funds over the past 10 years to maintain 5 miles (10 miles total including both sides) of rugged single-track dirt trails, clear fallen ash trees affected by emerald ash borers, and remove invasive honeysuckle and autumn olive. Highlighted their annual spring litter pickup along County Road and expressed a need for more volunteers and broader community awareness.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Superintendent Carl Malone delivered the parks report, updating the board on the State Conference in French Lick, winterization efforts, bath house roof inspections, splash pad troubleshooting with Vortex, and 2025 improvement plans for West Side Park (including skate park construction and playground replacements), Hein Park, and Allshire Park.
 - George Foley announced the upcoming Youth Employment and Resource Fair scheduled for January 4th, 2025, at Minista, sponsored by Northwest Bank. He also provided grant updates (Musco lighting, Pacer Foundation, IU

Community impact) and a successful Trunk or Treat event with over 1,000 children participating.

- Tonic reported on Prairie Creek Reservoir operations, noting the installation of a fence by American Water on the north side of the campground for security, ongoing shoreline cleanup, the addition of prehistoric/dinosaur fossil digging areas in the education center, and upcoming Flock license plate recognition cameras at three main vehicle entry points.
 - Board members discussed recovering surplus sports lighting, fencing, and scoreboards from a closing local sports complex via the Sanitary District for use at West Side Park.
 - Board members wished James Lutton a happy birthday.
 - **Adjournment:** Official adjournment via voice vote (unanimous).
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